

Questions to answer before you retire.



Retirement is not just a savings goal. It is a sequence of financial decisions that can affect your taxes, lifestyle, estate, and confidence for decades.

Kenneth Doll

Independent, fee-only, advice-only financial planning

RETIREMENT INCOME

TAX EFFICIENCY

ESTATE PLANNING

01

Can I retire, and will I have enough?

- What lifestyle can my savings support?
- How long does my money need to last?
- What happens if markets are weak early in retirement?
- Can I retire earlier than I thought?

03

When should I take CPP and OAS?

- Should I start CPP at 60, 65, 70, or somewhere in between?
- Will my income trigger OAS clawbacks?
- How does pension income affect the timing decision?

05

If I own a corporation, how should I use it?

- Should I pay myself salary, dividends, or a mix?
- How should retained earnings be accessed?
- What is the plan for corporate wind-down?

02

Which accounts should I draw from first?

- Should I use RRSPs, RRIFs, TFSAs, non-registered accounts, or corporate assets first?
- How much should I withdraw each year?
- Am I creating future tax problems by deferring withdrawals too long?

04

How will taxes affect my retirement income?

- What will my taxable income look like year by year?
- Can I reduce lifetime tax through better withdrawal sequencing?
- Will my estate face a large tax bill later?

06

How should my investments change in retirement?

- Is my portfolio built for withdrawals, not just growth?
- Do I have the right balance of risk and stability?
- What happens during inflation, higher rates, or market volatility?

Coordinate the plan, then keep it current.

The last questions connect retirement income decisions to estate planning, annual reviews, and an independent second opinion.

07 Is my estate plan coordinated?

- Will my assets pass the way I intend?
- Will my children be treated fairly?
- Could taxes or probate reduce what my family receives?

— WHAT A PLAN SHOULD GIVE YOU

- When you can retire
- How much you can spend
- Which accounts to use and when
- How CPP and OAS fit into the plan
- How to reduce tax over time

08 What should be reviewed every year?

- Investment returns, tax rules, health, family circumstances, spending needs, real estate, inheritances, and corporate changes.

— INDEPENDENT SECOND OPINION

Ken provides independent, fee-only, advice-only financial planning. He does not sell investment products and does not charge based on assets under management.

The goal is simple: a clear financial roadmap, explained in plain language, so you know what to do and when.

Kenneth Doll | BA, B.Comm., MA, CFP, CLU, TEP, ICD.D

Planning advice should be based on your personal situation. This handout is general information only.

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